

Ally Denton

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data analyst specializing in reproducible data analysis and statistical modeling using R, with experience working with large political and economic datasets. Skilled in data wrangling, exploratory data analysis, and statistical reasoning, including analysis of 200+ country-year observations. Background in risk analysis, compliance screening, and geopolitical data interpretation, with strong ability to communicate quantitative findings clearly.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Languages:

R (tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr), R Markdown, Excel, Git/GitHub

Data Analysis:

Data wrangling, tidying, cleaning, transformation, exploratory data analysis, function development

Statistics:

Hypothesis testing, descriptive statistics, probability, confidence intervals, regression basics

Visualization:

ggplot2, ggrepel, exploratory visualization, data storytelling, analytical charts, comparative analysis

Literate Programming & Workflow:

R Markdown, Quarto documents and presentations, reproducible research, version control, structured reporting

Data Acquisition:

CSV/API import, web scraping fundamentals, dataset construction and cleaning

EDUCATION

American University – School of International Service

MA International Affairs: Policy & Analysis (2025–2027) | GPA: 4.0

Relevant Coursework: Data Analysis, Statistics and Methods, Policy Analysis

University of Kansas

BA Global & International Studies; BA Political Science (Highest Distinction) (2021–2025) | GPA: 4.0

Minors: Intelligence & National Security Studies, Spanish

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

American University – Office of Global Safety & Risk Management

Student Assistant | *Nov 2025–Present*

- Analyzed global risk datasets to identify trends informing institutional decision-making.
- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative data into 5+ structured analytical reports.
- Supported development of reporting workflows for risk monitoring systems.

University of Kansas – Office of Global Risk & Security

Student Intern | *May 2024–July 2025*

- Conducted structured screening of entities using compliance and restricted-database systems.
 - Performed data organization and analysis to support international risk assessments.
 - Improved workflow efficiency through data tracking and documentation.
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APPLIED DATA ANALYSIS AND RESEARCH

Political Systems & Democratic Trends (V-Dem)

- Developed reproducible R Markdown workflows for political data analysis.
- Investigated global democratic trends using the Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Dataset, focusing on the Electoral Democracy Index (v2x_polyarchy) from 2010–2023.
- Examined patterns of democratic backsliding across countries through mapping and time-series analysis, emphasizing Latin America.

Economic Development & National Power Analysis (Regression Modeling)

- Modeled relationships between GDP per capita and national power indicators using regression analysis of a 250-country dataset combining World Bank and REST Countries API data.
- Developed reusable R functions for exploratory analysis and reporting workflows in R.